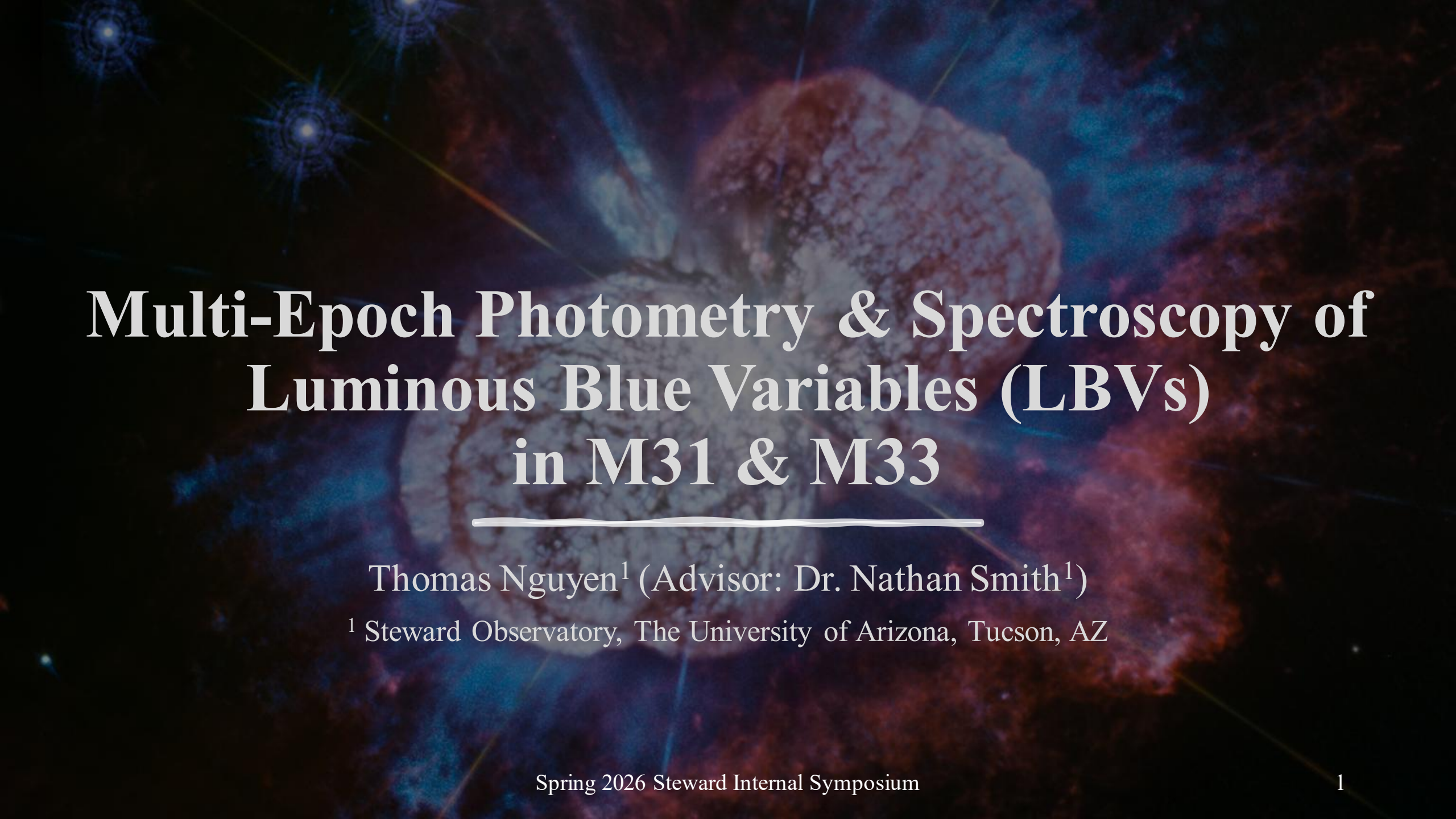


The background of the slide is a deep space image featuring a large, textured nebula in shades of blue and purple. Several bright stars are visible, some with prominent diffraction spikes. The overall color palette is dark with vibrant blue and purple highlights.

Multi-Epoch Photometry & Spectroscopy of Luminous Blue Variables (LBVs) in M31 & M33

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Agenda

- | | |
|----|-------------------------|
| 01 | Luminous Blue Variables |
| 02 | Methodology |
| 03 | Preliminary Results |
| 04 | Future Implications |

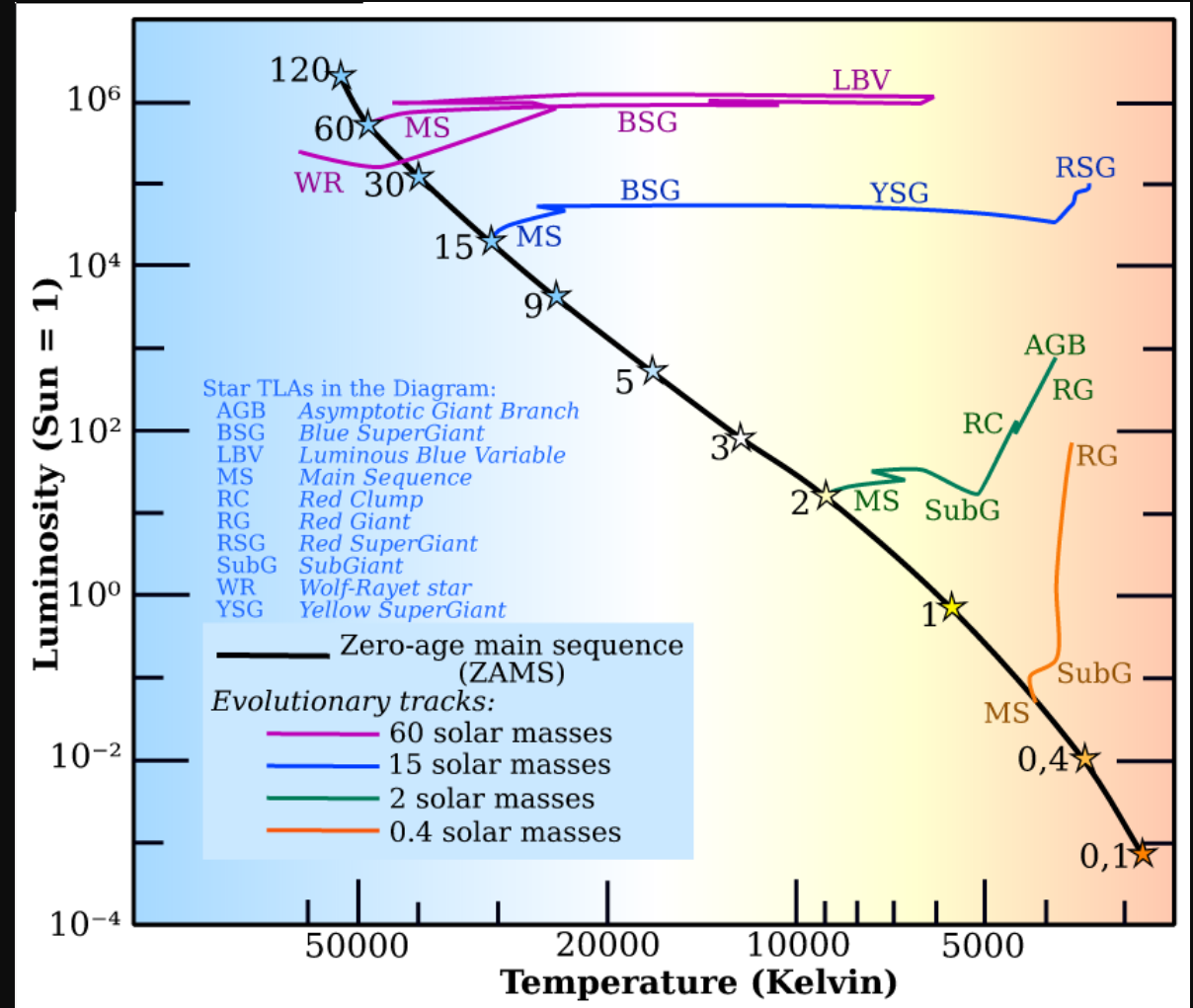


Credit: J. Morse (U of Colorado) & Hubble

1. Luminous Blue Variables (LBVs)

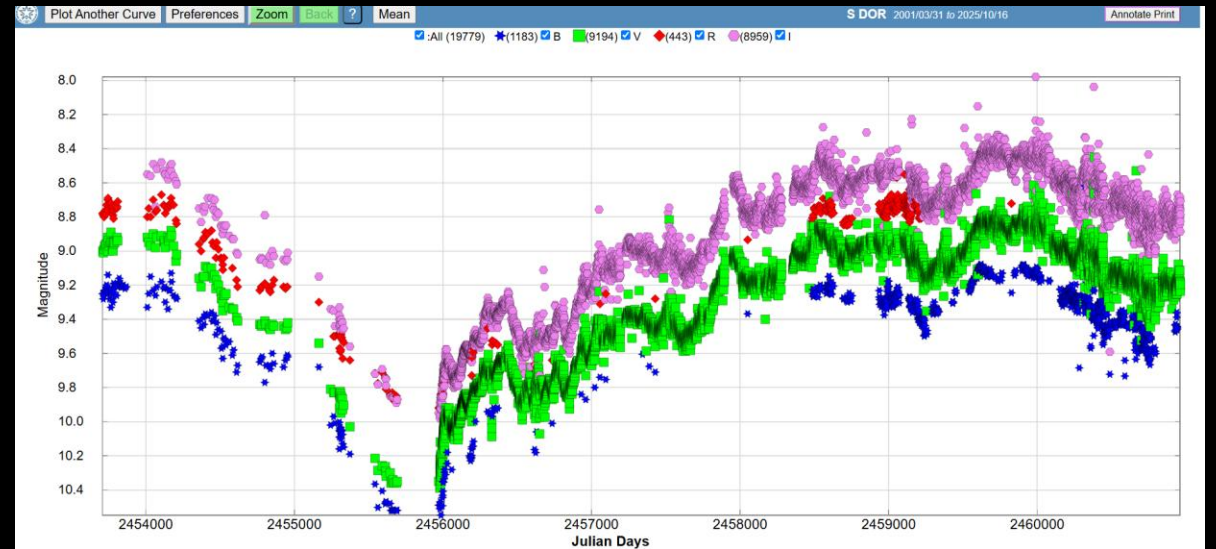
Post-MS Evolution of Massive Stars

- Post-MS evolution for stars with $M_{ZAMS} \geq 30 M_{\odot}$ is different from those with lower mass
 - Evolve with constant bolometric luminosity
 - Vary depending on luminosity
- E.g., stars with $\log\left(\frac{L}{L_{\odot}}\right) > 5.8$ may not become RSGs (Humphreys & Davidson 1994)
- Mass loss also plays a *deterministic* role (Smith & Tombleson 2015)
- One of the typical evolutionary scheme is: (Sholukhova et. al. 2018, see also Smith & Tombleson 2015)
 $O \rightarrow Of/ WNH \rightarrow \underline{LBV} \rightarrow WN \rightarrow WC \rightarrow SN$



LBVs

- Also classified as Hubble-Sandage variables (Hubble & Sandage 1953) or S Dor variables (Wolf 1989)
- Have the **highest** mass loss rates of any stars (Smith et. al. 2020)
- Unstable, massive, evolved stars with irregular outbursts, leading to the formation of a “pseudo-photosphere” (Szeifert et. al. 1996)



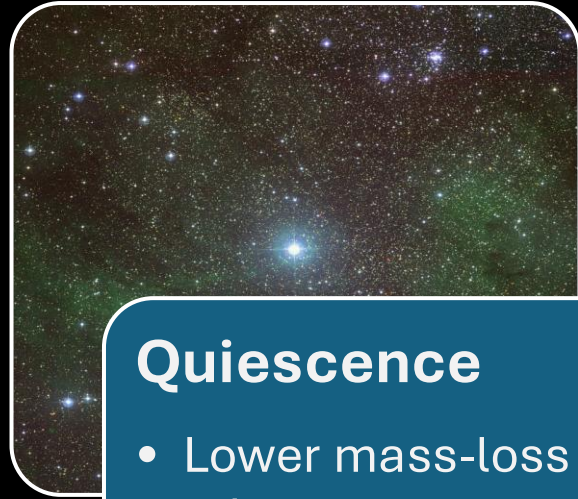
(Credit: AAVSO enhanced LCG)

Pseudo-photosphere?



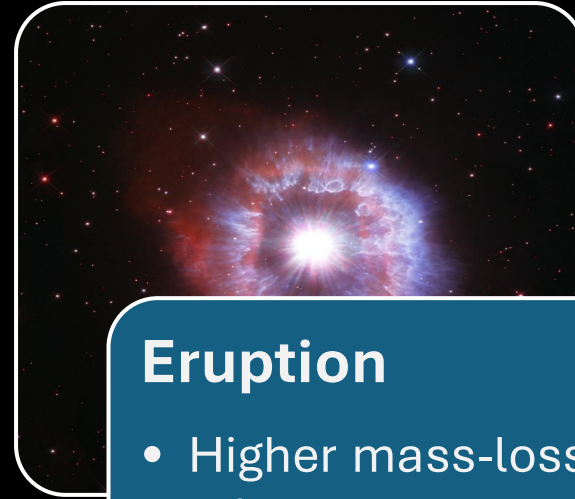
(Credit: NASA, ESA, STScI)

Pseudo-photosphere?



Quiescence

- Lower mass-loss rate
- “Normal” high temperature ($> 15,000$ K)

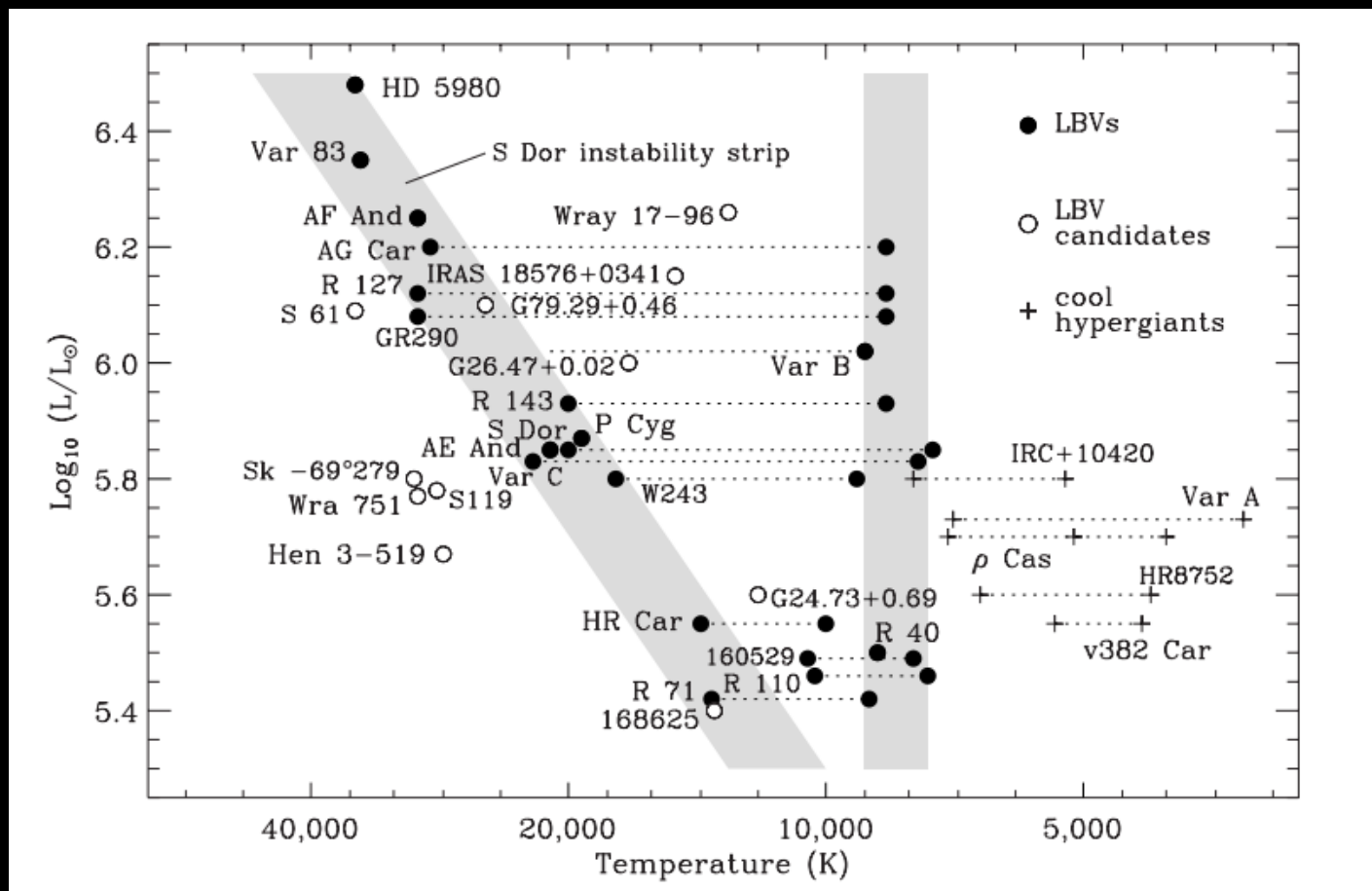


Eruption

- Higher mass-loss rate
- Cool (7000-9000 K) and dense ($N \sim 10^{11} \text{ cm}^{-3}$) expanding envelope

————→ Brightening in visible wavelengths at **constant bolometric luminosity**
(Szeifert et. al. 1996, see also Humphreys & Davidson 1994)

S Dor instability & constant-temperature strips



(Smith, Vink, & de Koter 2004)



2. Methodology

Spring 2026 Steward Internal Symposium

Methodology

- Photometry Data Acquisition:
 - All LBV and LBV candidates: John Martin at the University of Illinois Springfield Henry R. Barber Research Observatory
 - For M31 AE And & AF And and M33 Var 2 and Var C: American Association for Variable Star Observers
 - Also obtained data for M31 AE And, AF And, Var 15, Var A-1 and M33 Var B, Var C, Var 83, Var 2 from Szeifert et al. (1996)
- Spectroscopy from the MMT Observatory
- Data Analysis:
 - Calculate color index
 - Apply color correction: adopting A_V from Humphreys et. al. (2017)
 - Convert to absolute V-band magnitude
 - Plot a Color-Magnitude Diagram ($B - V$ vs. M_V)
 - Plot the change in $B - V$ against the change in M_V



(Credit: Steward Observatory)

Methodology

Table 2
Extinction, Luminosities, and Temperatures—LBVs and Candidates

Star	A_v (stars) (mag)	A_v (H II) (mag)	Adopted A_v (mag)	M_v (mag)	T (K)	M_{bol} (mag)	Stellar Group ^a
M31							
LBVs							
AE And	0.9(1)	0.9	0.9	−7.9:	20000:	−9.4:	A170, H II
AF And	...	1.1	1.1	−8.2:	28000:	−10.7:	...
Var A-1 ^b	1.4(1)	1.9	1.4	−8.7	21700	−10.6:	A42
Var 15 ^b	...	1.3	1.3	−7.3:	20200:	−9.1:	A38
M31-004526.62 ^c	1.6(1)	1.3	1.5	...	...	−9.65	A45, H II
LBV Candidates							
M31-003910.85	1.0(3)	1.0	1.0	−7.2	17400	−8.7	A127
M31-004051.59 ^d	1.7	1.6	0.6	−8.1	9000	−8.4	A82
M31-004411.35	2.3(1):	0.8	2.3:	−8.6	17400	−10	A10
M31-004425.18 ^e	...	0.7	0.7	...	18000	−8	isolated(A9)
M31-004444.00	0.5(3)	1.0	0.5	−5.9	20700	−7.7	A54
M33							
LBVs							
Var B	0.4	0.3	0.4	−7.7	24000:	−10.0	A142
Var C ^f	0.5(2)	0.4	0.5	−8.6	20000:	−9.8	H II
Var 83	0.8(2)	0.9	0.8	−8.8:	28000:	−11.1:	A101, A103, H II
Var 2	0.9(1)	1.0	0.9	−7.2	28000:	−10.0:	A100
LBV Candidates							
M33C-2976	0.4(2)	0.5	0.4	−5.9	17000	−7.2	A124
M33C-4174	0.8(3)	0.9	0.8	−7.3	19900	−9.0	A130
UIT008 ^g	0.4(1)	0.8	0.6	−7.5	34000	−10.7	H II, A27
M33C-14239	0.3(2)	0.4	0.4	−7.6	16600	−9.0	Spiral arm
M33C-4640 ^h	0.6(2)	0.6	0.6	−8.1	9000	−8.3	A128
M33C-25255	0.7(3)	0.6	0.6	−6.3	24500	−8.6	A137
M33-013317.22	0.7(2)	0.5	0.7	−6.5	29100	−10.0	A17
M31-013334.06	...	0.6	0.6	−7.6	19800	−9.3	...
M33C-7024	0.3(3)	0.3	0.3	−6.3	25200	−8.6	Spiral Arm
M33C-15235	1.1(4)	0.8	1.0	−7.8	29200	−10.4	A64
M33C-5916	0.7 (1)	0.6	0.7	−6.9	34000	−10.0	A6
M33-013406.63 ⁱ	0.8(1)	0.7	0.7:	−9.1:	29200:	−12.6:	H II
M33C-21386	0.9(4)	1.0	0.9	−8.2	...	...	A71
M33C-10788	0.8(3)	0.5	0.8	−7.3	32000	−10.3	A100
M33-013424.78	...	0.9	0.9	−8.8	13700	−9.4	A102
M33C-20109	2.4(1):	...	2.4:	−8.5	...	...	...
M33-013432.73	0.6(2)	0.6	0.6	−6.0	21700	−9.0	A84, N604
M33C-16364	0.4(6)	0.5	0.4	−6.7	31100	−9.4	A88
V532/GR290 ^j	...	0.6	0.6	var	42000–22000	−10.4–10.7	A89:

Methodology

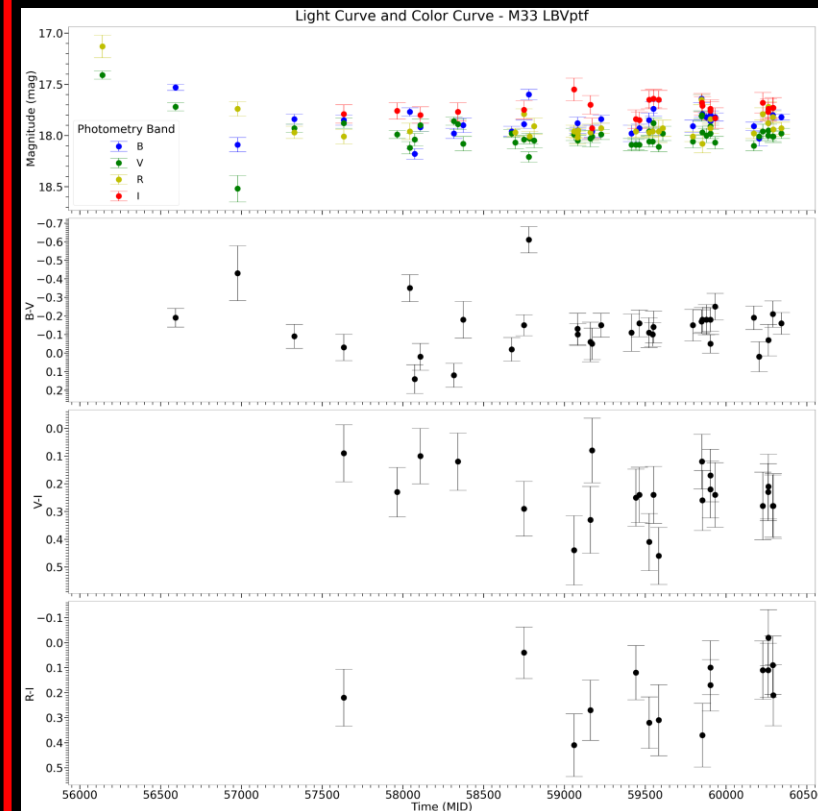
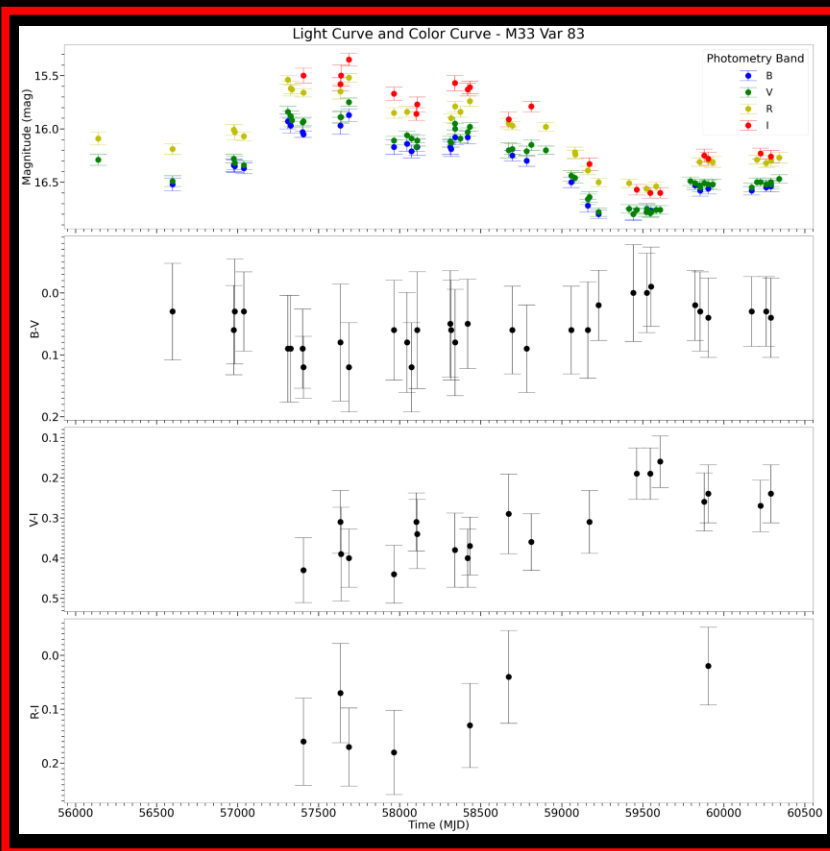
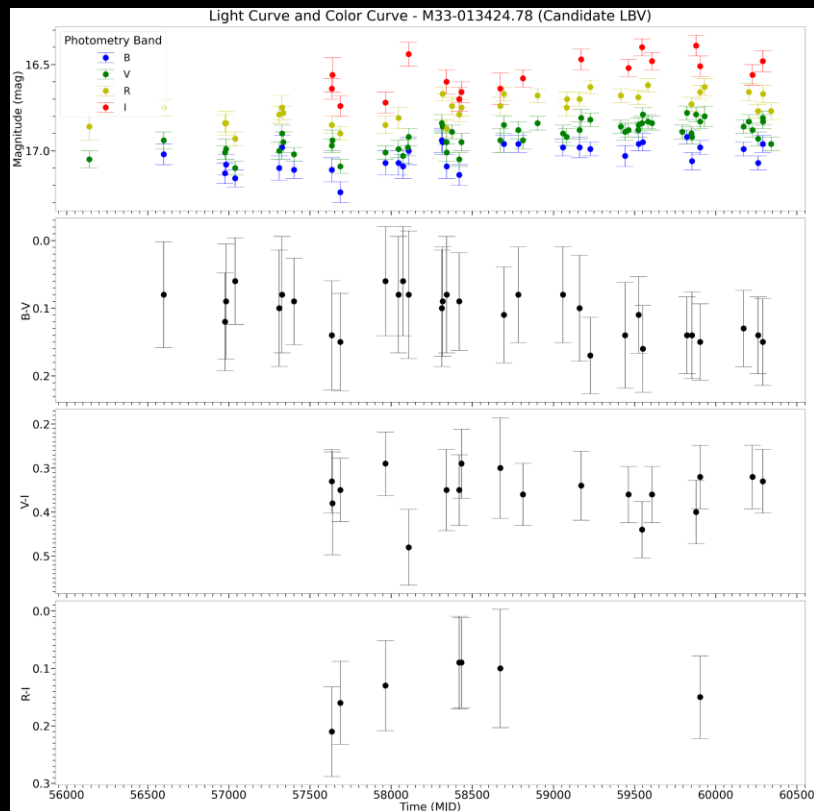
Table 3
Extinction, Luminosities, and Temperatures—B[e] Supergiants and Warm Hypergiants

Star	A_V (stars) (mag)	A_V (H I) (mag)	Adopted A_V (mag)	M_V (mag)	T (K)	M_{Bol} (mag)	Stellar Group ^a
M31							
B[e] Supergiants							
M31-004043.10 ^b	1.5(1)	0.8	1.0	−6.8	16500	−8.4	A120
M31-004057.03	...	0.7	0.7	−6.3	7700:	−6.2:	...
M31-004220.31 ^b	...	1.1	1.1	−6.6	12500	−7.7	...
M31-004221.78 ^b	...	0.95	1.0	−5.8	7200:	−7.0	...
M31-004229.87 ^b	1.4(2)	2.1	1.4	−7.0	17600	−8.8	...
M31-004320.97 ^b	...	1.5	1.5	−6.7	10500	−7.9	...
M31-004415.00 ^b	...	0.9	0.9	−7.0	17300	−8.9	...
M31-004417.10 ^b	0.7(1)	1.7	0.7	−8.0	13800	−9.0	A32:
M31-004442.28 ^b	1.2(1)	1.7	1.2	−5.9	26900	−8.6	...
Warm Hypergiants							
M31-004322.50 ^b	1.5(1)	1.1	1.5	−5.6	8200	−6.2	Spiral Arm
M31-004444.52 ^b	1.5(3)	1.3	1.5	−7.8	6600	−8.4	A41
M31-004522.58 ^b	1.2(1)	1.1	1.2	−7.1	11000	−7.7	A46
M31-004621.08 ^b	1.2(1)	0.3	1.2	−7.6	10000	−8.0	A104:
M33							
B[e] Supergiants							
M33-013242.26	0.7(2)	0.8	0.7	−7.8	22900:	−9.3	A118
M33-013324.62 ^b	...	0.4	0.4	−5.3	22800	−7.6	...
M33C-7256 ^b	0.5(3)	0.3	0.5	−5.6	18400	−8.0	A14
M33C-6448	0.5(2)	0.8	0.5	−6.9	17300	−8.3	A9
M33C-24812 ^b	...	0.7	0.7	−6.2	20000	−8.0	A35
M33C-15731 ^b	1.2(2)	0.7	1.2	−8.9	21700	−11.0:	A64(bulge)
M33-013426.11 ^b	...	0.6	0.6	−6.1	12300	−7.2	...
M33-013459.47 ^b	...	0.7	0.7	−6.8	23200	−9.0	...
M33-013500.30 ^b	0.3(3)	0.7	0.3	−5.5	16200	−7.2	A88
Warm Hypergiants							
Var A ^{b,c}	0.6–0.9	1.0	...	...	7000:	−9.5	A130
B324 ^d	0.9(3)	0.8	0.8	−10.2	8000	−10.1	A67
N093351 ^{b,e}	0.45(2)	0.8	0.45	−8.8	7800	−8.8	A142
N125093 ^{b,e}	0.9(1)	0.8	1.6	−8.8	7500	−8.9	A105
J013358.05+304539.9 ^{b,f}	0.8(2)	0.6	0.8	−9.2	5000–6000	−9.3:	A68

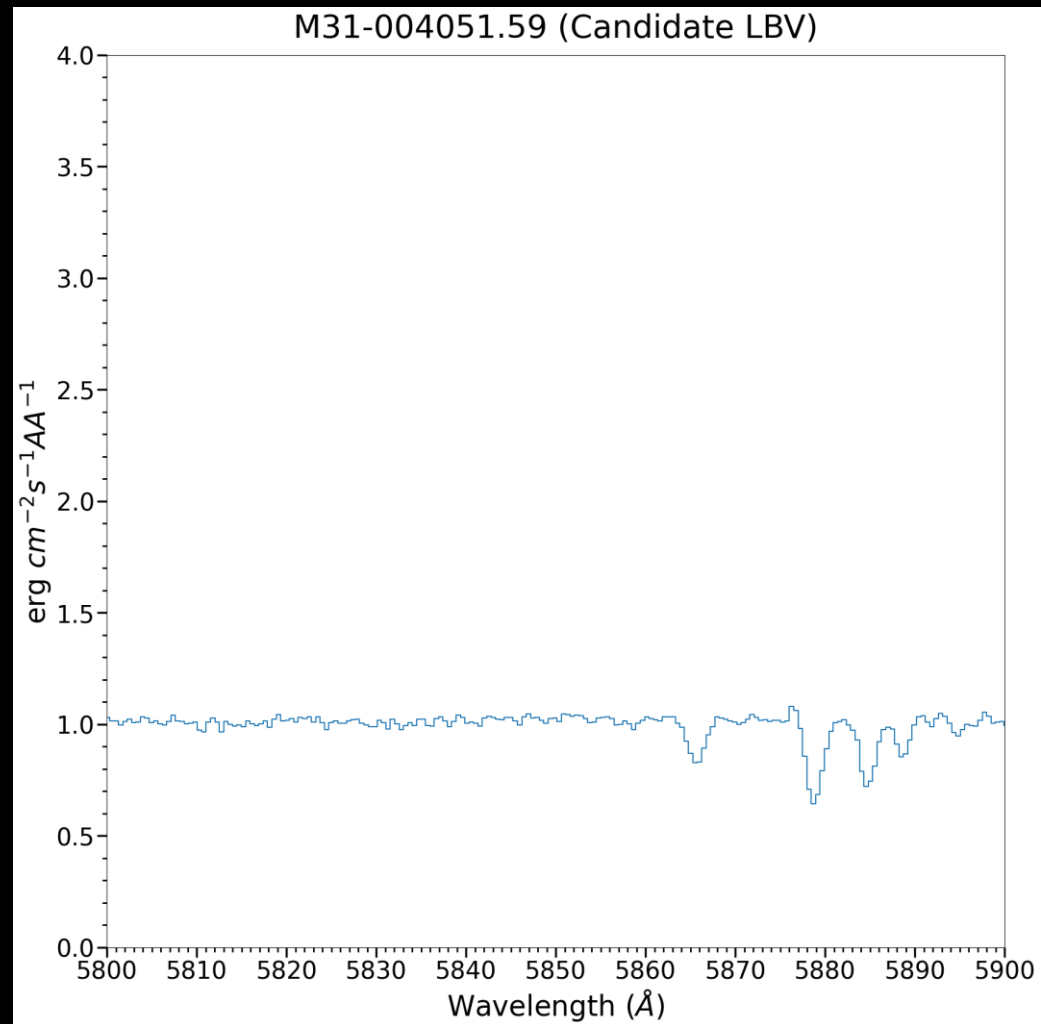
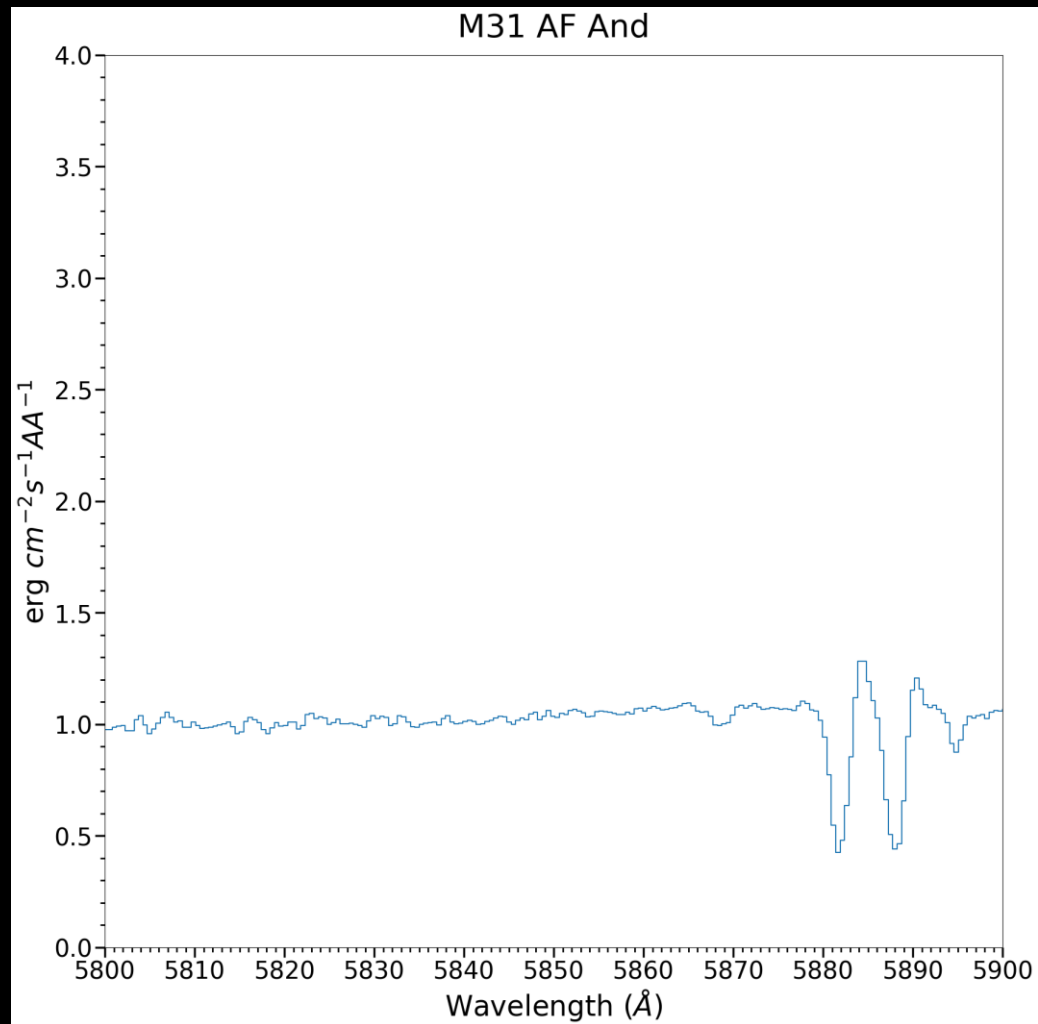


3. Preliminary Results

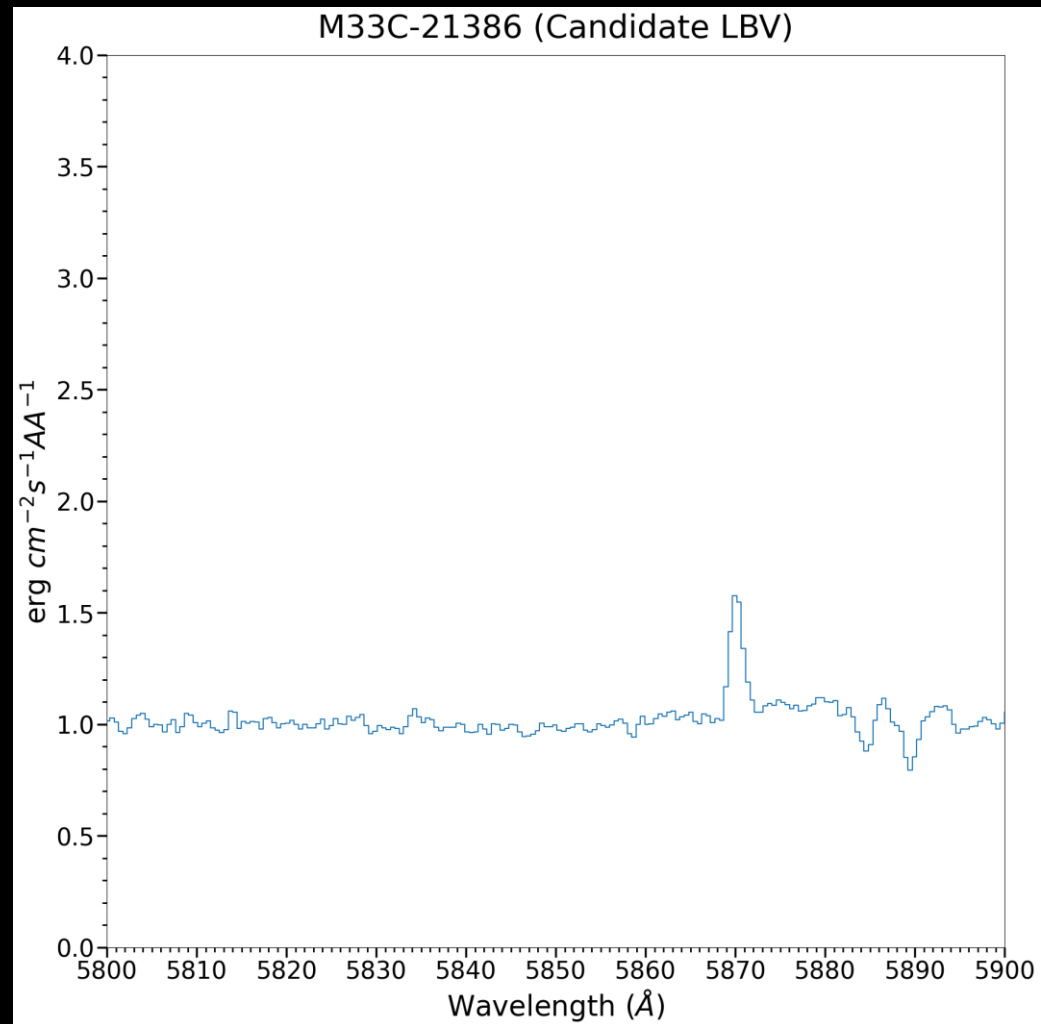
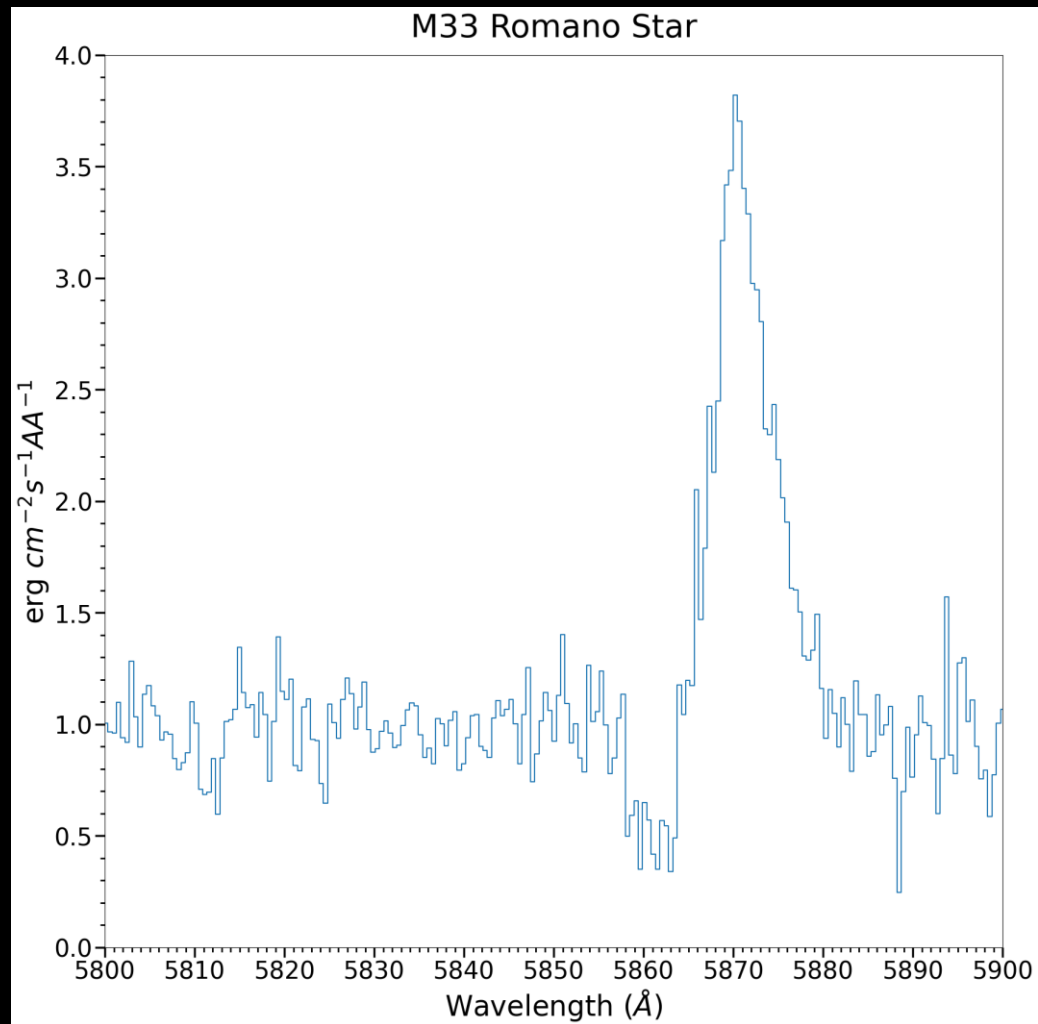
Light Curves and Color Curves



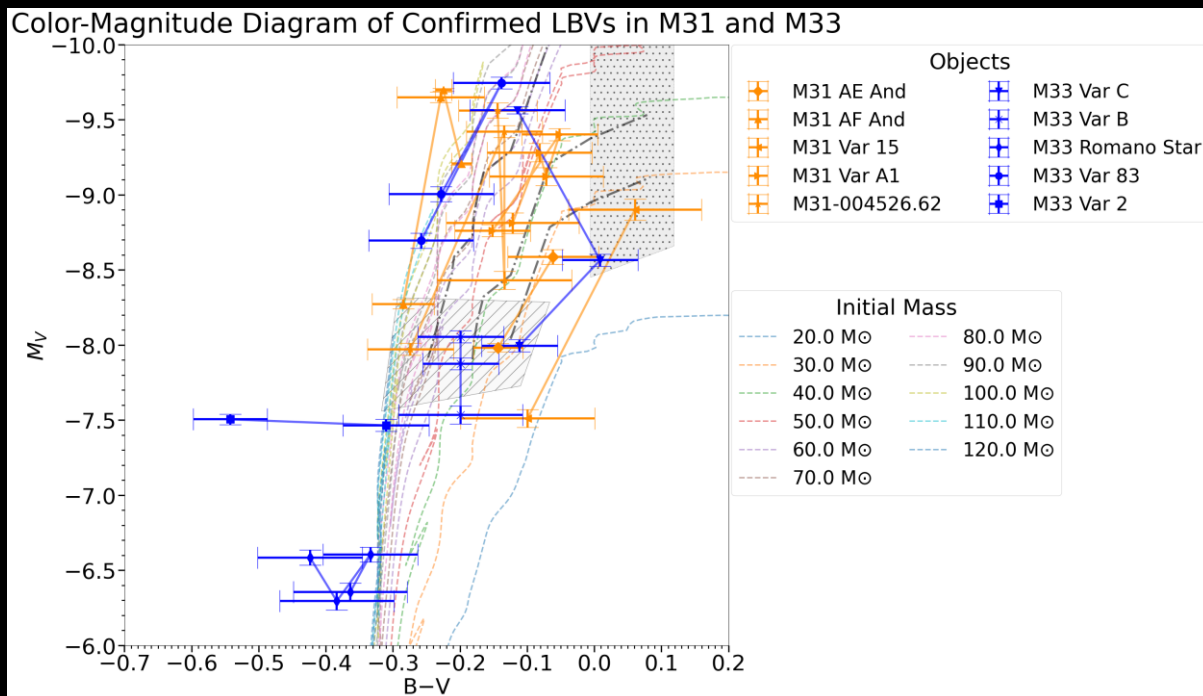
M31 Objects' Spectra



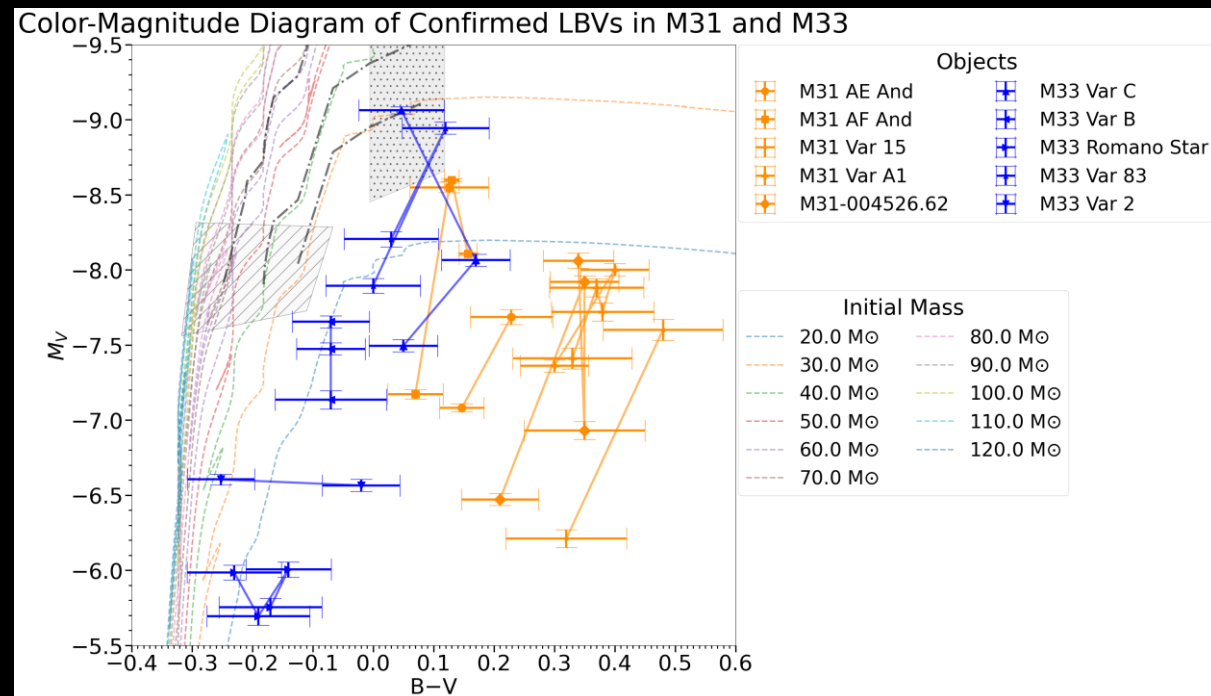
M33 Objects' Spectra



Color-Magnitude Diagram

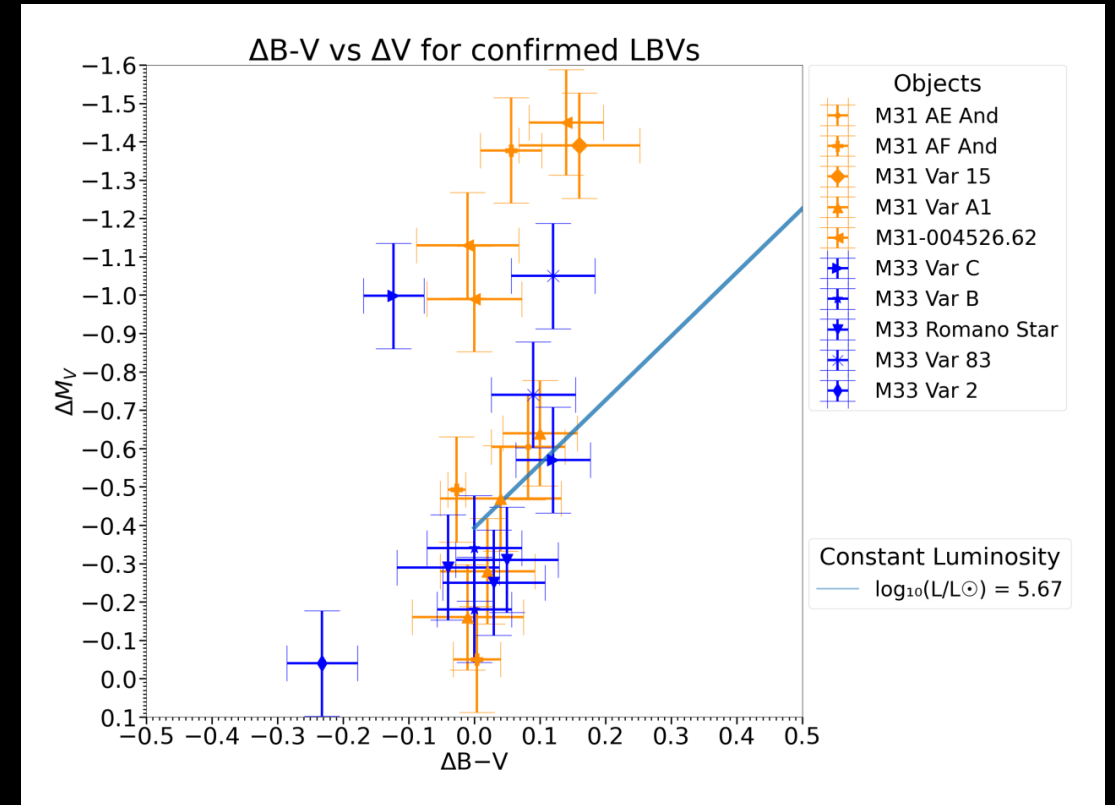
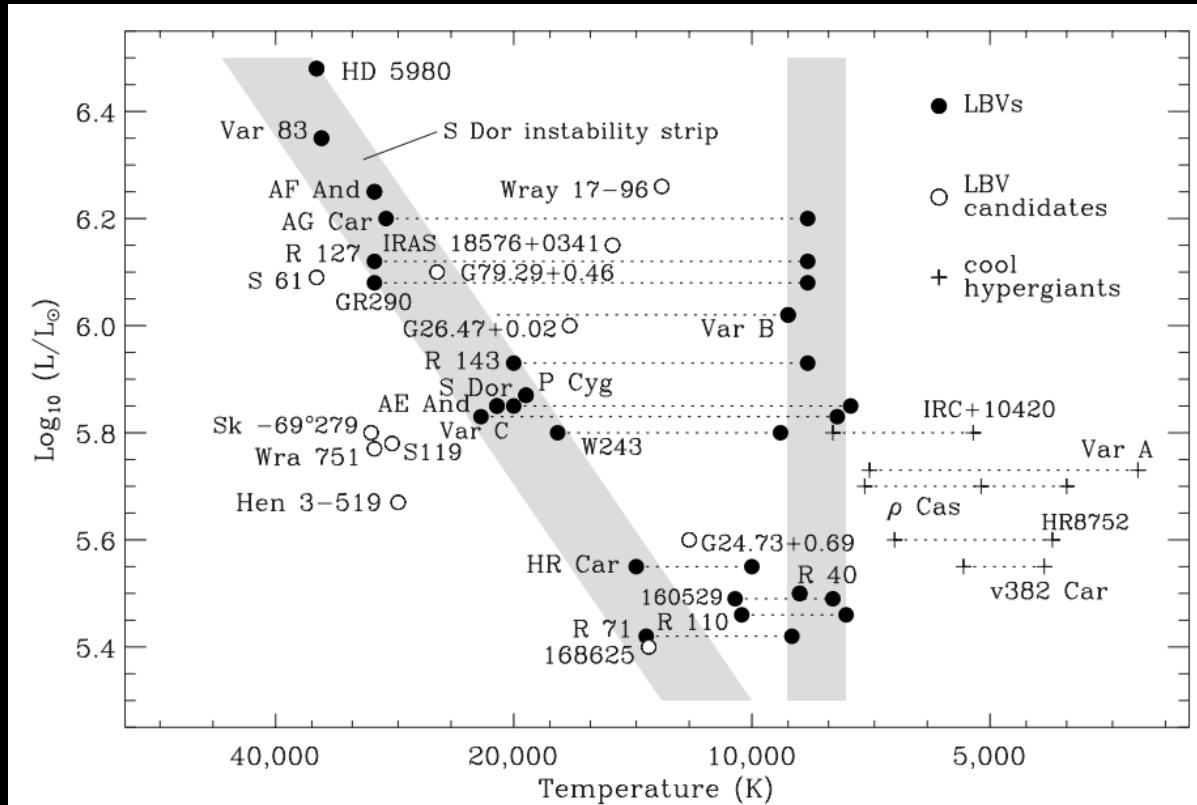


Adopted A_V from Humphreys (2017)



No color-correction

$\Delta(B - V)$ vs. ΔV

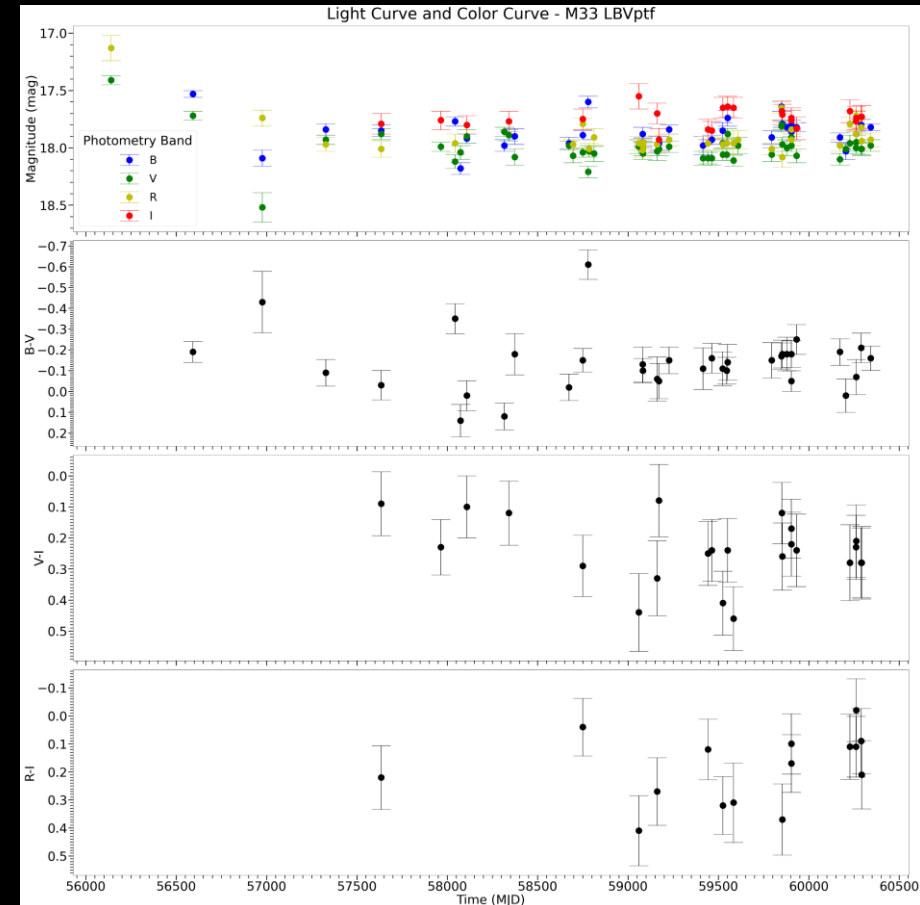
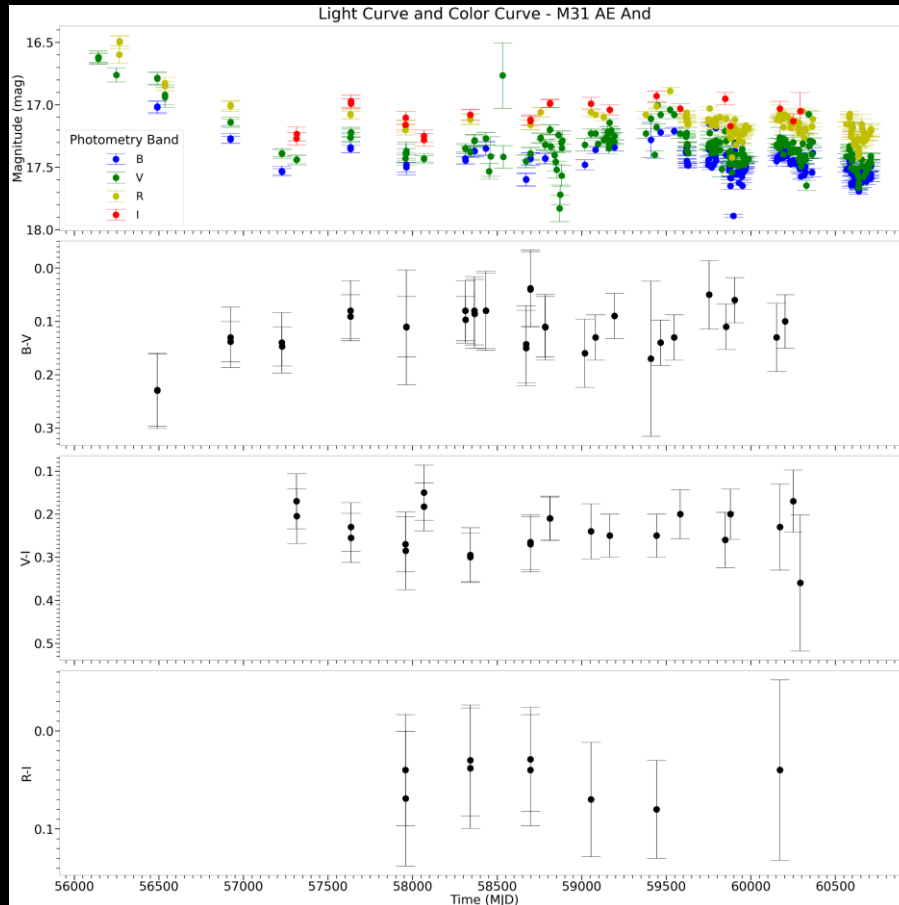




4. Future Implications

Future Implications

- Obtain more photometry to capture missing outbursts

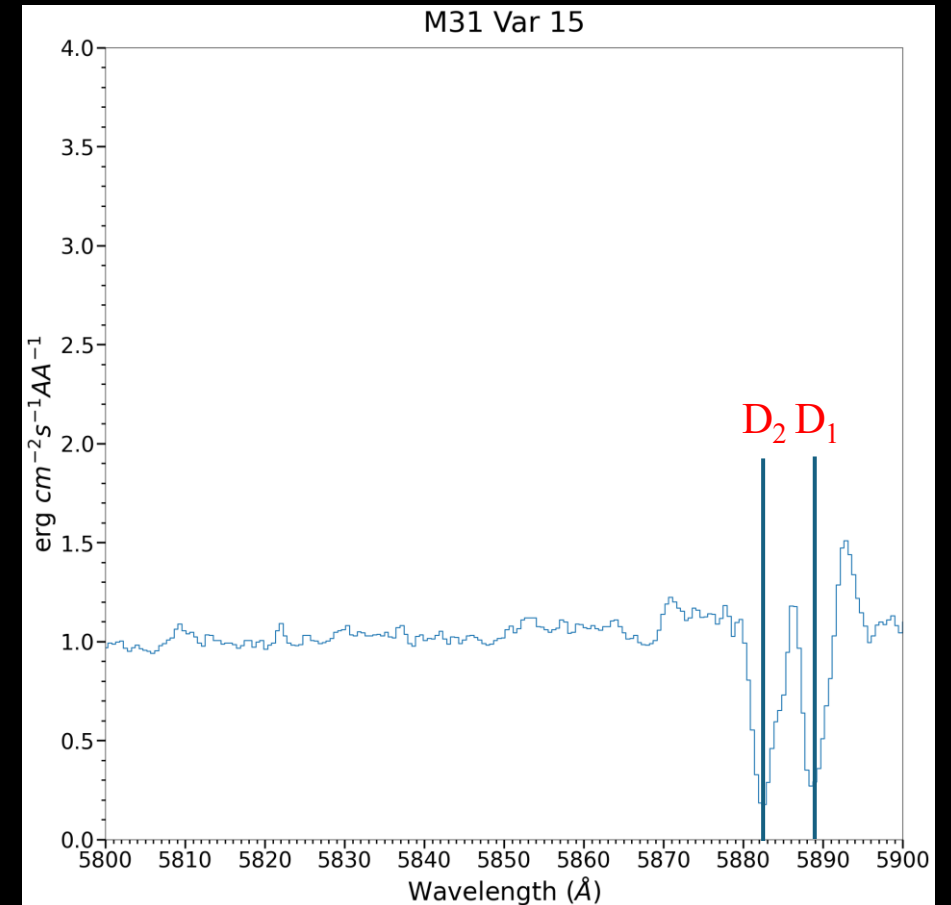


Future Implications

- A different color correction method with Na I D absorption lines

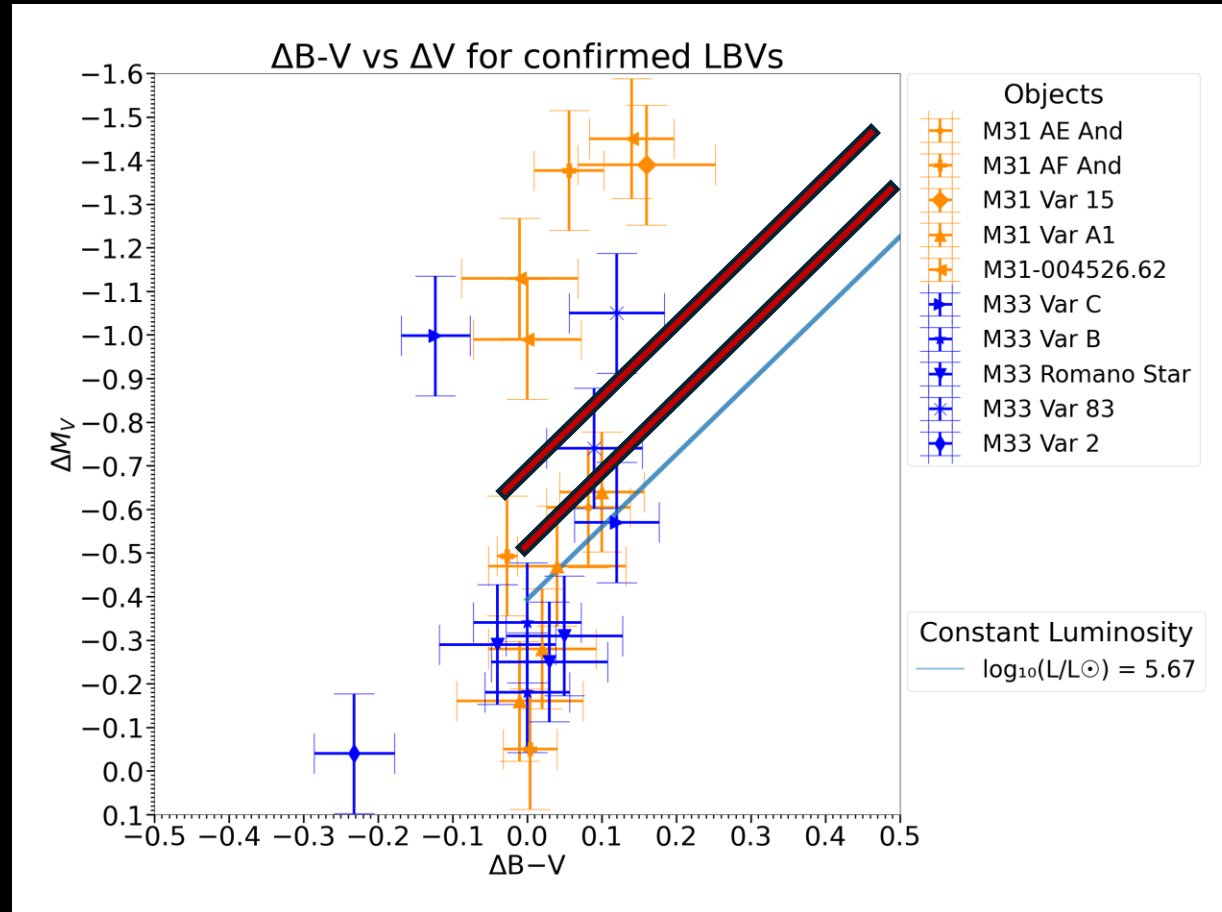
$$\log_{10}(E_{B-V}) = 1.17 \times EW(D_1 + D_2) - 1.85 \pm 0.08$$

(Podnanski et al. 2012)



Future Implications

- Do they get brighter with constant bolometric luminosity?



References

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Takeaways

- LBVs are evolved, massive stars that brightens in optical wavelengths at constant bolometric luminosity
- Current photometry shows that they become reddened as they become brighter during eruptions
- Future implications include obtaining more photometry and applying a new method of color-correction using sodium absorption lines